

Epitaph of Seikilos

"I am a tombstone, an image. Seikilos placed me here as a long-lasting sign of deathless remembrance."

Text: Greek: Seikilos, ca. 1st-2nd c.
tr. Kenan Schaeferkofer, 2021
EPITAPH OF SEIKILOS irregular

Music: Seikilos, ca. 1st-2nd c.



The musical score is written on two staves in 6/8 time. The first staff contains the first line of the song, and the second staff contains the second line. The lyrics are written below the notes, with Greek text on the top line and English translation on the bottom line. The music is a single melodic line with various note values including quarter, eighth, and sixteenth notes, as well as rests.

Hó - son zêis, phaí - nou mē - dèn hó - lōs sù lu - poû
While you live, shine bright. Let not grief sour your guest, Life,

pròs ol - í - gon és - ti tò zên tò té - los ho khró - nos a - pai - teî.
stay-ing with you, but for a while. Soon will come due all de-mands of Time.